

GUIDELINES FOR THE PREPARATION OF REPORTS BY MEMBER STATES ON THE APPLICATION OF THE 1974 RECOMMENDATION CONCERNING EDUCATION FOR INTERNATIONAL UNDERSTANDING, CO-OPERATION AND PEACE AND EDUCATION RELATING TO HUMAN RIGHTS AND FUNDAMENTAL FREEDOMS

I. Introduction

A. About the 1974 Recommendation

1. UNESCO's *1974 Recommendation concerning Education for International Understanding, Co-operation and Peace and Education relating to Human Rights and Fundamental Freedoms*¹ (the "*1974 Recommendation*") aims to promote international education and world peace through understanding, solidarity and cooperation. It was adopted on 19 November 1974 by the General Conference of UNESCO at its 18th session.

2. The *1974 Recommendation* applies to formal, non-formal and informal education and to all levels, from pre-primary to tertiary and adult education and lifelong learning. The General Conference recommended "*that Member States should apply*" the provisions included in the *1974 Recommendation* "*by taking whatever legislative or other steps*" that provide institutional (e.g. policies and legal frameworks) and pedagogical (e.g. curricula, teacher training, educational materials, equipment, and student assessment) support for its implementation, based on the "*objectives*", referred to in paragraph 4 of the *1974 Recommendation*, "*regarded as major guiding principles of education policy*" including: an international dimension and a global perspective on education, cultural diversity, interdependence, communication, rights and responsibilities, international solidarity and cooperation, and problem solving.

3. Today, the principles of the *1974 Recommendation* apply equally well to Education for Sustainable Development (ESD) and to Global Citizenship Education (GCED) and therefore represent a powerful tool for promoting the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and in particular SDG Target 4.7 on the promotion of sustainable development and global citizenship through education, Target 12.8 on access to information on sustainable development and Target 13.3 on climate change education.

4. The General Conference in its 39th session recommended the use of the *1974 Recommendation* reporting process to support the implementation and monitoring of Target 4.7 of Sustainable Development Goal 4 (39 C/Resolution 79). The UNESCO Executive Board at its 209th session approved the use of the current guidelines for both the monitoring of the *1974 Recommendation* and the collection of data needed for the following global SDG indicator for which UNESCO is custodian (209 EX/Decision 18.II):

4.7.1, 12.8.1 and 13.3.1: *The extent to which (i) global citizenship education and (ii) education for sustainable development are mainstreamed in (a) national education policies; (b) curricula; (c) teacher education and (d) student assessment.*

5. Questions marked with an asterisk (*) will be used in the calculation of the respective indicators (**Table 1**). As approved by the Inter-Agency and Expert Group on the SDG Indicators, the indicators will be calculated for primary and secondary education only.

Table 1 Questions used in the calculation of the global SDG indicator for Targets 4.7, 12.8 and 13.3

Policies	Curricula	Teacher education	Student assessment
A2, A4, A5, E1a	B2, B3, B4, E1b	C2, C3, C4, C5, E1c	D2, D3, E1d

¹ http://portal.unesco.org/en/ev.php-URL_ID=13088&URL_DO=DO_TOPIC&URL_SECTION=201.html

B. Reporting obligations

6. The General Conference, at its 18th session, when adopting the *1974 Recommendation* recommended “*that Member States submit [...] reports concerning the action taken by them in pursuance of this recommendation*”. Moreover, in accordance with Article VIII of UNESCO’s Constitution “*Each Member State shall submit to the Organization [...] reports [...] on the action taken upon the recommendations and conventions referred to in Article IV, paragraph 4.*”

7. Thus, **all UNESCO Member States are expected to report on the steps they have taken to implement the 1974 Recommendation** preferably by completing the following questionnaire. Such reporting takes place every four years.

II. Guidelines for completion of the questionnaire

8. This questionnaire and its accompanying guidelines are addressed to Ministers responsible for relations with UNESCO. The questionnaire is typically completed by Ministries of Education and other government authorities responsible for education. Responses should cover, as far as possible, education at all levels of government, including sub-national levels where applicable as well as education outside the government sector.

9. National respondents are encouraged to **consult widely** both within, across and beyond government, including with Ministries of Environment, with national human rights institutions, the education sector, civil society partners and others, as necessary, to gather the information needed to complete the questionnaire.

10. Responses to the seventh consultation should cover:

- (i) the time period 2017-2020;
- (ii) education at all levels of formal education from pre-primary to tertiary education as well as non-formal education;
- (iii) all levels of government that have responsibility for education within the country; and
- (iv) where possible, education outside the government sector.

11. To assist countries in responding to this questionnaire, UNESCO has developed the following set of global citizenship education and education for sustainable development themes. The list is based on a review of current common practices in many countries as well as a review of relevant literature. While the terms ESD and GCED may be used differently in some countries, the list of themes typically captures what are seen as key elements of Target 4.7. Please refer to the definitions of key terms in **Section III** before completing the questionnaire.

Global citizenship education and education for sustainable development

- 1. cultural diversity and tolerance
 - 1.1 international or intercultural understanding, solidarity and cooperation
 - 1.2 intercultural and interreligious dialogue
 - 1.3 local, national and/or global citizenship
- 2. gender equality education
 - 2.1 gender-based equal opportunities
 - 2.2 gender equality and justice
 - 2.3 gender roles, identity and stereotypes

3. human rights education
 - 3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status
 - 3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation
 - 3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)
4. peace and non-violence
 - 4.1 friendly relations among peoples and nations
 - 4.2 challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together, including others and preventing violent extremism
 - 4.3 preventing all forms of violence including bullying, verbal abuse and gender-based violence
5. climate change education
 - 5.1 mitigation
 - 5.2 adaptation
 - 5.3 impact reduction
 - 5.4 early warning
6. environmental sustainability
 - 6.1 caring for the planet, protecting nature
 - 6.2 environmental justice
 - 6.3 biodiversity, water
7. human survival and well-being
 - 7.1 environmental health as it pertains to human well-being, disaster risk reduction
 - 7.2 health of the planet for future generations
 - 7.3 sustainable cities and communities
8. sustainable consumption and production
 - 8.1 responsible and sustainable lifestyles
 - 8.2 green economy, green jobs
 - 8.3 sustainable energy

III. Definitions of key terms

Term	Definition
Themes of global citizenship and education for sustainable development	
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	<i>Education about and for diversity including language, ethnicity, race, religion as well as the development of tolerance, mutual respect and appreciation for cultural diversity. It includes intercultural and interreligious dialogue, understanding, solidarity and co-operation, and citizenship education.</i>
2. Gender equality education	<i>Education that addresses the wider issue of gender equality by promoting new attitudes and patterns of belief, transforming the way people think about traditional gender roles and helping to build long-term sustainable change. It examines how gender roles, activities, needs, opportunities, rights and entitlements affect men, women, girls and boys differently. It deals with the relationships between females and males, their access to and control of resources and the constraints they face relative to each other. It respects the rights of all learners – women, men, boys and girls – equally and gives equal access to learning opportunities, resources and protections. All learners benefit from and are treated in education equally without the limitations set by stereotypes, rigid gender roles and prejudices. It covers gender-based equal opportunities, gender equality and justice, and gender roles, identity and stereotypes.</i>
3. Human rights education	<i>Education that promotes universal respect for and observance of all human rights and fundamental freedoms and thus contributes, inter alia, to the prevention of human rights violations and abuses by providing persons with knowledge, skills and understanding and developing their attitudes and behaviours, to empower them to contribute to the building and promotion of a universal culture of human rights.</i> <i>It includes equality and non-discrimination, human rights values, dignity, justice, inclusion and participation and respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms.</i>
4. Peace and non-violence	<i>Education about peace and peace-building, mediation, conflict prevention and resolution, non-violence, reconciliation and living together peacefully. It includes advocating for friendly relations among peoples and nations, challenging negative stereotypes, promoting peaceful solutions, learning to live together and preventing violent extremism and other forms of violence including bullying.</i>
5. Climate change education	<i>Education to help people, in particular youth, understand, address, mitigate, and adapt to the impacts of climate change. It encourages changes in attitudes and behaviours needed to put the world on a more sustainable development path, and build a new generation of climate change-aware citizens.</i> <i>It covers various responses to climate change including mitigation, adaptation, impact reduction and early warning.</i>
6. Environmental sustainability	<i>Education about responsible interactions with the environment to avoid depletion or degradation and to promote environmental quality and health. It includes, caring for the planet and protecting nature, environmental justice, biodiversity and water.</i>
7. Human survival and well-being	<i>Education that promotes social well-being and harmony including in future generations due to healthy environmental systems. It includes health of the planet and environment related to human well-being, disaster risk reduction and sustainable cities and communities.</i>

8. Sustainable consumption and production	<i>Education on the use and production of resources, products and services that have a minimal adverse impact on the environment. It promotes resource and energy efficiency, sustainable infrastructure and green jobs. It includes responsible and sustainable lifestyles, the green economy and sustainable energy.</i>
Dimensions of learning	
Knowledge	<i>Factual information and understanding acquired through study and/or experience.</i>
Skills	<i>The ability to carry out a task well as a result of training, practice and innate aptitude. Skills may be physical, mental or both.</i>
Values	<i>Principles that form the foundation on which individuals conduct themselves and interact with others and with the environment around them.</i>
Attitudes and behaviours	<i>Ability to act on the basis of beliefs and knowledge acquired through study or experience.</i>
Levels of education	
Pre-primary	<i>Education designed to support children's early cognitive, physical, social and emotional development and introduce young children to organized instruction outside of the family context. Participants are usually aged from three years.</i>
Primary and secondary	<i>Education designed to:</i> <i>(i) provide students with fundamental skills in reading, writing and mathematics (i.e. literacy and numeracy) and establish a solid foundation for learning and understanding core areas of knowledge and personal development (primary education); and</i> <i>(ii) prepare students for further education at post-secondary and tertiary levels and for entry into the labour market (secondary education).</i> <i>It includes both general and vocational education.</i>
Tertiary	<i>Education designed to provide learning activities in specialised fields of education. It aims at learning at a high level of complexity and specialisation. It includes both what is commonly understood as academic education and advanced vocational or professional education.</i>
Types of education	
Adult education	<i>Education specifically targeted at individuals who are regarded as adults by their society to improve their technical or professional qualifications, further develop their abilities, enrich their knowledge with the purpose to complete a level of formal education, or to acquire, refresh or update their knowledge, skills and competencies in a particular field.</i>
Formal education	<i>Education that is institutionalized, intentional and planned through public organizations and recognized private bodies which – in their totality – constitute the formal education system of a country. Formal education programmes are recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities. Formal education consists mostly of initial education (e.g., pre-primary, primary, secondary and tertiary education).</i>
Non-formal education	<i>Education that is an addition, alternative and/or a complement to formal education within the process of the lifelong learning of individuals. It is often provided to guarantee the right of access to education for all. It caters to people of all ages but does not necessarily apply a continuous pathway-structure. It may be short in duration and/or low-intensity, and it is typically provided in the form of short courses, workshops or seminars. Non-formal education mostly leads to qualifications that are not</i>

	<i>recognized by the relevant national or sub-national education authorities or to no qualifications at all. Non-formal education includes programmes on life skills including literacy and numeracy, work skills, and social or cultural development. Most types of adult education are also included.</i>
Vocational education	<i>Education that is designed for learners to acquire the knowledge, skills and competencies specific to a particular occupation or trade or class of occupations or trades. Vocational education may have work-based components (e.g. apprenticeships). Successful completion of such programmes leads to labour-market relevant vocational qualifications acknowledged as occupationally-oriented by the relevant national authorities and/or the labour market. Vocational education can be offered at secondary and post-secondary or tertiary levels of education.</i>

IV. Information about the respondent

Country:

Republic of Korea

Organization:

Korean National Commission for UNESCO

Date of submission:

31 January 2021

V. Other contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire

Please indicate below the names of other organizations and contributors consulted during the completion of this questionnaire.

Government institutions including other Ministries (please specify):

Ministry of Education

National human rights institutions (please specify):

National Human Rights Commission of Korea

Local and regional authorities responsible for education (please specify):

17 Metropolitan and Provincial Offices of Education (MPOEs)

Other local and regional authorities (please specify):

Organizations representing education stakeholders (e.g. teachers, students, parents, etc.) (please specify):

Experts from the Korean Institute for Curriculum and Evaluation (KICE); the Korea Institute of Child Care and Education (KICCE); GCED Lead Teachers/Study Groups (supported by MOE, MPOEs, and APCEIU); the Research Institute of GCED for Primary and Secondary Education (a group of teachers and school leaders for research and professional development, supported by the Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education); and teachers in vocational education.

Other civil society organizations (please specify):

The largest association of NGOs in international development education in South Korea; and a network of NGOs and educators in peace education.

Others (please specify):

The response to this survey questionnaire was coordinated and drafted by the **Asia-Pacific Centre of Education for International Understanding under the auspices of UNESCO (APCEIU)**

VI. Questionnaire

A. Laws and policies (preamble and paras 4 and 7 of the 1974 Recommendation)

A1a. Please describe any specific national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal framework(s) in your country that govern the promotion of global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes² are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

[Laws, Legislation or Legal Framework]

The Republic of Korea (hereinafter referred to as the ROK, the Republic of Korea, or South Korea, interchangeably) has a number of laws that govern the promotion of GCED and ESD as articulated in SDG 4.7 / SDG 4.7.1 and in this survey framework. They can be classified into two streams.

The first stream is legislation established for certain thematic areas of 4.7 (e.g., human rights, gender equality, multiculturalism, the environment, peace, etc.) in which the education/training of key stakeholders is made mandatory or, if not, which provides legal grounds for the provision of such education/training. For instance, the National Human Rights Commission of Korea Act aims to "contribute to the recognition of human dignity and worth as well as to the safeguarding of the basic order of democracy by establishing the National Human Rights Commission to ensure that inalienable fundamental human rights of all individuals are protected and the standards of human rights are improved." (Article 1) The Act specifies that one of the duties of the Commission is "education and promotion of human rights" (Article 19 Clause 5). It also grants authority and responsibility to conduct education on human rights and consult on human rights education with the Minister of Education (for curricular integration), and the heads of schools/state agencies/research institutions/lifelong education organizations (Article 26 (Education and Promotion of Human Rights)). Similar trends may be found in most of the laws **listed in A1b**.

Second, but more importantly, there is **legislation on education** that articulates concepts, philosophies, principles, and values that are in line with SDG 4.7 and therefore safeguards the legal grounds to promote SDG 4.7.

The most important of all is the Framework Act on Education* Article 1 of which states that the purpose of the Act is to "provide for the rights and duties of citizens and the obligations of the state and local governments on education, and prescribe an educational system and fundamental matters for its operation." Article 2 of this legislation clearly sets out the purpose of education as follows:

"Education shall aim at enabling every citizen to lead a life worthy of humankind and to contribute to the development of a democratic state and the realization of an ideal of human co-prosperity, by ensuring cultivation of character, development of abilities for independent life, and necessary qualities as a democratic citizen under the humanitarian ideal" (Article 2 [Principle of Education]).

There are some cultural and linguistic nuances in this Article for which it is difficult to find English equivalents, but when this Article evokes the importance of "an ideal of human co-prosperity" and "humanitarian ideal" the former refers to general co-prosperity of humankind and the latter refers to *Hongik Ingan*, a Korean term that can roughly be translated as "widely benefiting humankind." In other words, it suggests that the ultimate ideal of education is to "pursue the common good of humanity."

In addition, Article 29 (Globalized Education) emphasizes the importance of international cooperation and capacity-building in order for people to serve as a productive members of the global community:

- ① The State shall make efforts to provide globalized education for citizens to be equipped with attainments and abilities as members of the global community.

(...)

² See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

- ④ The State shall provide policies for educational cooperation with foreign governments and international organizations.

The Framework Act on Education also reinforces the promotion of some other thematic areas relevant to SDG 4.7. For instance the cross-cutting issue of gender equality is emphasized in the Act, for example, in Article 17-2, where it states, "[T]he State and local governments shall formulate and implement policies to achieve gender equality in a more active way." In various ways, the legal frameworks on education and on thematic areas in SDG 4.7 reinforce one another or further develop each other's agendas through cross-referencing.

* In 1997, the Framework Act on Education replaced the Education Act that had been enacted in 1949. The Act is the foundation and core document that prescribes the basic elements of South Korea's education system and guarantees the right to education. (National Archives of Korea, 2006).

Lastly, the ROK also has a legal framework to promote and support UNESCO activities, called the **Act on UNESCO Activities**. This Act is intended "to prescribe matters required to allow the Korean Government and people actively participate in the activities of the United Nations Educational, Scientific and Cultural Organization, in order to embody the noble spirit pursued by the United Nations Charter, the United Nations Educational Scientific and Cultural Organization Charter, and the Universal Declaration of Human Rights, as well as matters required for assisting such activities." The Act also provides a legal basis for the establishment, roles and activities of the Korean National Commission for UNESCO (KNCU) and the Asia-Pacific Centre of Education for International Understanding (APCEIU) through which SDG 4.7 is being actively implemented in South Korea.

A1b. Please provide the full names of any laws, legislation or legal frameworks referred to in A1a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

* Official English translations are available. Please click the hyperlinks.

[1. Framework Act on Education](#)

[2. National Human Rights Commission of Korea](#)

[3-1. Framework Act on Gender Equality](#)

[3-2. Enforcement Decree of the Framework Act on Gender Equality](#)

[4. Unification Education Support Act](#)

[5-1. Act on the Prevention of and Countermeasures Against Violence in Schools](#)

[5-2. Enforcement Decree of the Act on the Prevention of and Countermeasures Against Violence in Schools](#)

[6. Youth Activity Promotion Act](#)

[7. Child Welfare Act](#)

[8-1. Multicultural Families Support Act](#)

[8-2. Enforcement Decree of the Multicultural Families Support Act \(Presidential Decree\)](#)

[9. Environmental Education Promotion Act](#)

[10. Social Welfare Services Act](#)

[11-1. Character Education Promotion Act](#)

[11-2. Enforcement Decree of Character Education Promotion Act](#)

[12. Act on UNESCO Activities](#) * English translation is available only as document. No website link is available.

*A2 Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national laws, legislation or legal frameworks on education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	National				Sub-national			
	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal	Pre-primary	Primary/secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1

A3a. Please describe any specific current national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives in your country that promote global citizenship education (GCED) and/or education for sustainable development (ESD). Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes³ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

The Republic of Korea launched its Comprehensive Plan for Sustainable Development in 2006. This Plan is closely aligned with the SDGs, particularly since its 3rd version, published in 2016. The 4th Plan (2021-2040) is now being reviewed for approval. The Plan is led by the Ministry of Environment in consultation and coordination with all other relevant ministries, including the Ministry of Education for SDG 4. A Commission for the K-SDGs (a version of the SDGs adapted to the South Korean context) has also been set up and is currently in operation. As the Plan covers all 17 K-SDGs and is led by the Ministry of Environment, there is always the possibility that education may not gain prominence in this comprehensive national plan. Therefore, for SDG 4, especially for SDG 4.7, the policies and action frameworks of the Ministry of Education (MOE) and those of the 17 Metropolitan and Provincial Offices of Education (MPOEs)* are more important and have greater effect.

* In South Korea the MOE establishes key policy frameworks on specific issues/thematic areas at the national level and each MPOE then establishes its own respective policy framework in line with those of the MOE. Each MPOE is independent and has the power to choose its own foci and develop its own programmes depending on the local context and demands.

All the themes of ESD/GCED listed in this questionnaire are explicitly mentioned in key policy documents of both the Ministry of Education and the 17 MPOEs, though each theme is included to varying degrees. Some themes, such as education for gender equality and human rights, are considered to

³ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

be cross-cutting themes and are most explicitly backed up by the legal framework, whereas some others, such as peace and non-violence, human survival and well-being, and sustainable consumption and production, are promoted mostly through school-based activities supported by MPOEs. The most visible themes in terms of policies concerning learning content and large-scale budgetary and policy support can be observed in the policies concerning ‘democratic citizenship education,’ on the one hand, and ‘multicultural education’ and ‘environmental education’, on the other, all of which are covered by policy plans announced each year by the MOE, and subsequently MPOEs. As mentioned in section A1 above, democratic citizenship education has a firm basis in the Framework Act on Education as well as the national curriculum framework, while multicultural education and environmental education also have specific legal frameworks explicitly and exclusively dedicated to them. Policies for multicultural education in South Korea used to be narrowly focused on support for ‘multicultural families’ with an ‘assimilationist’ perspective in the past, but the policy perspective has changed significantly since 2016 into more of a ‘global citizenship’ perspective emphasizing the values of inclusion and pluralism and invoking a broader identity as members of the global community. From a slightly different angle, South Korea’s ‘Character Education’ also contains policy frameworks supporting SDG 4.7. Although Character Education was initially introduced from a more conservative perspective, it is also becoming more aligned with education for democratic citizenship and global citizenship under a 2nd comprehensive plan (2021-2025) for this type of education established under the current government. In addition, since 2020, particularly with the pandemic and growing awareness of environmental issues, South Korea has also witnessed a burgeoning emphasis on education related to sustainable development. Led by the Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education, the country’s 17 MPOEs are preparing comprehensive plans for what they call ‘education for ecological transition.’

GCED/ESD themes are explicitly mentioned in the aforementioned policy documents as key features. GCED/ESD per se are also explicitly mentioned in the policy frameworks as interlocking or cross-cutting themes, or presented as specific education programmes and activities. The MOE and MPOEs have also been establishing various annual plans for specific education programmes exclusively for GCED/ESD, such as the Annual Plan for the GCED Lead Teachers Programme (Ministry of Education, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020). A number of MPOEs have also established their own policy frameworks. For example, the superintendent (a position elected by local popular vote)* of the Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education (2018-2022) put ‘peace’ as one of his seven campaign pledges (Goal 4: Peace). The pledge included a number of themes related to SDG 4.7 in its targets, such as ‘(4-1-1) Foundations for and Implementation of Peace Education,’ ‘(4-2-2) Comprehensive Implementation of Multicultural Education,’ ‘(4-3-1) Promotion of Global Citizenship Education,’ and ‘(4-3-3) Global Exchange and Cooperation for Internationalization of Education.’

* The superintendent (the highest post in each MPOE) in South Korea is an official elected by a local popular vote. Since 2014, the majority of the superintendents (14 out of 17 MPOEs) elected through local elections are deemed ‘progressive’, implying in South Korea that they tend to be committed to education for democratic citizenship, peace, social justice, gender equity, multiculturalism, and environmental sustainability. Even those MPOEs that do not fall into such a political category would still perceive GCED to be highly necessary in terms of the skills required for the globalizing world of the 21st century.

[Additional Information from APCEIU’s research on monitoring in South Korea] APCEIU, as a UNESCO Category 2 Centre specialized in GCED, has been assigned as the focal point for SDG 4.7 in South Korea, APCEIU’s host country. In this context, APCEIU has been making additional efforts to develop a monitoring system for SDG 4.7 in South Korea since 2018. In 2020, APCEIU conducted a study to refine and validate the GCED indicator system proposed for South Korea in its previous studies, in line with SDG 4.7.1, the global indicator to monitor the mainstreaming of GCED/ESD in four domains. The study first involved a Delphi survey and expert consultation to build a refined list and classification of GCED-related thematic areas and keywords contextualized for South Korea, and align these with global indicators to establish a set of sub-indicators for the South Korean context. The sub-indicators were then pilot-tested by codifying and statistically analyzing key policy documents and the curricula of Teacher Education Institutes (TEIs) to validate the sub-indicators and to examine the extent to which GCED is mainstreamed in South Korea in the given domains.

The 2020 study investigated the extent to which GCED is mainstreamed in education policies by examining the policies of the 17 Municipal and Provincial Offices of Education (MPOEs) through the set of indicators and sub-indicators developed. In particular, the study examined which division and personnel are in charge of GCED – and which thematic areas those divisions focus on – as well as the proportion that each thematic area occupies within the relevant budget and within policy projects. The study also examined which thematic areas of GCED are prevalent and prominent in each MPOE to identify key entry points for GCED in each local context. The study concluded that there has been a gradual increase in personnel and departments related to GCED, yet the existence of a division fully dedicated to GCED varies by region. It was found that most of the MPOEs have a division for democratic citizenship education, to which work related to GCED may be assigned. The proportion of GCED-related topics in policy projects varies greatly by region, and the most prominently addressed topic is ‘global citizenship,’ followed by ‘cultural diversity.’ In terms of project type, teaching-learning activities within schools constitute the highest proportion, whereas curriculum development projects are the least facilitated. In terms of thematic areas by budget allocation, the highest proportion of the budget goes to projects on ‘cultural diversity,’ followed by ‘global citizenship’ and ‘human rights.’ Most of the projects on ‘cultural diversity’ fall under the framework of ‘multicultural education policy projects’. Most of the projects that explicitly focus on ‘global citizenship’ are from the ‘democratic citizenship education’ budget, but this tendency also varies greatly from one region to another.

A3b. Please provide the full names of any **education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives** referred to in A3a and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

The following policy documents are available only in Korean. All the comprehensive or annual plans by the MOE on specific themes are followed by those of the MPOEs, which align both with MOE frameworks and with locally specific foci and contexts.

* Official English translation is not available. The hyperlinks are for the websites in Korean.

- [Annual Plan for Education, MOE](#)
- Annual Plans for Education from each of the 17 MPOEs
- [Annual Plan for Multicultural Education, MOE](#)
- Annual Plans for Multicultural Education from each of the 17 MPOEs
- [Annual Plan for Global Citizenship Education \(Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education 2017\); Superintendent's Campaign Pledges \(2018-2022\)](#)
- Operation Support Plan for ASPnet (Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education, 2017)
- 2nd Comprehensive Plan for Environmental Education (2016-2020) (the 3rd Plan is currently in preparation)
- Comprehensive Plan for the Promotion of Democratic Citizenship Education (MOE, 2018)
- [Plans for Democratic Citizenship Education for Schools from some of the 17 MPOEs](#)
- 2nd Comprehensive Plan for Character Education
- Various Plans related to human rights and human rights education (MOE, MPOEs) (e.g., Plan for the Promotion of Labor-related Human Rights Education, MOE, 2020)
- Annual Plan for GCED Lead Teachers Programme (MOE, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020)

*A4. Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are covered in national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives affecting each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*A5 Please indicate whether national or sub-national education policies, frameworks or strategic objectives on education provide a mandate to integrate GCED and ESD in the following areas by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown, 99 = not applicable (e.g. where the given level of government is not responsible for education)

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
Design or revision of the curricula	1	1	1	99*
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	1	1
Textbook development	99	1	99*	99*
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	99	1	9	99*
Sub-national				
Design or revision of the curricula	99	1	99*	1
Setting of programme learning objectives	1	1	99*	1
Textbook development	99	1	99*	99*
Teacher education and training	1	1	1	1
Assessment of student outcomes	99	1	9	99*

* “99” in Tertiary and Non-formal education simply means that for those specific areas, it is individual institutes, organizations and practitioners, not central or local governments or authorities, who hold the responsibility and authority to establish their own plans, policies, strategies, and actions.

B. Curriculum (paras 4 and 10-19 of the 1974 Recommendation)

B1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in school curricula. Indicate whether topics are taught as standalone subjects or are integrated into the curricula of other subjects. Explain whether GCED and/or ESD themes⁴ are mentioned explicitly or are inferred and what types or levels of education are covered.

[2015 Revised National Curriculum]

Framework : GCED/ESD values and principles reflected in education goals and philosophies

There is a significant overlap, both explicit and implicit, between the philosophy and goals of education in South Korea and the values and philosophies of GCED/ESD. As elaborated below, the key aspects of GCED and ESD, specifically the emphasis on holistic education, global citizenship, respect for diversity and human dignity, and communal values for humankind, are represented in the Framework Act on Education and the National Curriculum (covering primary and secondary education) of the Republic of Korea.

The values and principles of GCED/ESD are both explicated and implied in the Framework 2015 Revised National Curriculum, which is currently in effect. The Framework starts with the ultimate goal of education in South Korea as based on the ideal of *Hongik Ingan**, which aims to enable every citizen to lead a life worthy of human dignity, contribute to the development of a democratic state, and support the realization of an ideal of shared human prosperity, by ensuring the cultivation of character, development of abilities for an independent life, and the necessary qualities to be a democratic citizen under the humanitarian ideal.

* *Hongik Ingan* : The founding philosophy of the first kingdom in Korea, with the meaning of ‘contributing to the overall benefit of humankind.’

Based on this ideal and ultimate goal of education, the ‘Vision of an Educated Person’ in the National Curriculum is specified as follows:

- A. A self-determined person who cultivates his/her identity and actively develops his/her career and life through holistic growth/development;
- B. A creative person who pursues novelty and innovation through diverse ideas and challenges while firmly grounded upon basic competencies;
- C. A cultivated person who appreciates and promotes the cultures of humankind on the basis of cultural literacy and understanding of diverse values; and
- D. A person who lives in harmony with others, fulfilling the ethics of caring and sharing, as a democratic citizen with a sense of community and connection to the global world.

Such values and philosophies are expected to be diffused throughout the subject-specific curricula as well – although there are still some segments of subject content that present contradictory positions and need further modification in the future.

The Framework also articulates the concept of ‘Equal Opportunities for All Students’, which has much in common with the values of GCED/ESD. For instance, the Framework encourages schools and educators to:

- A. Guide students to avoid biases about gender roles, educational levels and occupations, religions, regions of residence, ethnicities, nationalities, and so forth.
 - B. Provide support for authentic learning experiences for slow learners, students with disabilities, gifted students in certain areas, returnees from overseas, students from multicultural families, and so forth.
- (...)

⁴ See the schema described in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

- E. In the case of courses on religion, schools must offer multiple courses on different religions to ensure students' right of choice. However, in the case of religion-affiliated schools, where students enroll willingly, a single course may be offered with the consent of parents and students.

GCED/ESD content integrated into various/relevant subjects

First, throughout the subject-specific curricula across grades, concepts such as sustainable development, global citizenship, social justice, human rights, peace and non-violent conflict resolution, gender equity, anti-discrimination, multiculturalism and pluralism, democracy, cooperation among individuals, and international cooperation, among other relevant topics, are **explicitly introduced as learning content as well as values to cultivate**. This is achieved mostly through, but not limited to, subjects like social studies and ethics.

In addition to **sometimes explicitly and directly discussing GCED/ESD themes**, the subject-specific curricula **also offer various entry points through which GCED/ESD themes can be introduced**. Both of these approaches take place through the main components of the curricula, called 'achievement standards (expected learning outcomes)', 'learning elements', and/or 'teaching-learning methods.' Achievement standards (or expected learning outcomes) are particularly important since they also set the range of content and competencies on which students will be assessed. Therefore, teachers are expected to cover all these achievement standards in one way or another. GCED/ESD themes often appear in these achievement standards, which provide the strongest entry points for mainstreaming when it comes to the curriculum. **For example**, 'Moral Education,' one of the mandatory subjects for primary and lower secondary education in South Korea, has achievement standards/expected learning outcomes as follows:

[**Moral Education for Grade 6 (Unit 03-04)**] Discuss the problems that human beings face in the era of globalization and their root causes; develop the willingness to solve such problems and act upon it. 1) What are the various problems of the global community that we experience, and how can we raise moral sensitivity towards such global issues? 2) What are ways to solve such global issues and how can we make the right decisions to solve them?

[**Moral Education for Grade 9 (Unit 03-01)**] Understand that human dignity, human rights, and gender equality are universal values from a moral standpoint; be able to empathize with and care about others, based on due respect for their human rights and resistance against various forms of social prejudices. 1) Why are human dignity and human rights important? 2) How do we treat social minorities? 3) How do we promote gender equality?

[**Moral Education for Grade 9 (Unit 03-03)**] Cultivate the ethics of a global citizen by understanding moral values/ethics required for global citizens, recognizing various moral issues arising in the global community and developing a pro-active attitude to participation in solving such problems. 1) Am I global citizen? 2) What are the ethical/moral issues that global citizens face? 3. How can we solve these ethical/moral issues?

[**Moral Education for Grade 9 (Unit 04-01)**] Understand the importance to human life of humanity living in harmony with nature; understand the need for the protection of the environment from various perspectives. Evaluate the impact of human consumption patterns on the environment from the point of view of ecological sustainability; acquire practical environmentally-friendly life skills. 1. Are human beings the master of nature? 2. What are the connections between environmental values and consumption patterns? 3. What concrete action can be taken for an eco-friendly life?

Further examples of the subject-specific curriculum in various subject areas are presented in **B1b** below.

GCED/ESD themes as cross-cutting themes and issue areas

According to the National Curriculum, “the following cross-curricular themes* should be incorporated into the entire educational programme including subject-area teachings and Creative Experiential Activities, and should be delivered in collaboration with families and local communities.”

* **Cross-curricular themes** are as follows. Each theme also has a couple of sub-set themes. GCED/ESD themes are highlighted in bold.

Safety·Health Education, **Character Education**, Career Education, **Democratic Citizenship Education**, **Human Rights Education**, **Multicultural Education (global citizenship education included)**, **Unification Education (peace education included)**, Dokdo Education, Economy·Finance Education, **Environmental-Sustainable Development Education**

The National Curriculum in South Korea now offers teachers greater autonomy in terms of time, content and resources than was previously the case. If interested and competent, teachers can create their own lesson plans with greater flexibility in terms of the sequence and combination of various learning outcomes specified in the national curriculum, including the choice of specific topics through which to explore the target issues/thematic areas, and the choice of teaching/learning materials and resources. An increasing number of teachers experiment and regularly operate cross-subject classes with their fellow teachers in other subject areas. Such interdisciplinary classes offer a rich platform to explore GCED/ESD themes in greater depth.

GCED/ESD implemented as non-subject or cross-subject classes through Creative Experiential Activities (clubs, etc.) and the Exam-Free Semester system

The National Curriculum has what it calls ‘**Creative Experiential Activities**’ (CEA) within its regular curricular hours, which are “designed to develop students’ talents and potential, and to nurture a sense of community.” CEA includes “discretionary activities, club activities, community services, and career-related activities.” As schools have full autonomy over how to organize their CEA, the growing interest in GCED/ESD and their thematic areas among teachers and school leaders in recent years is often translated into the implementation of GCED/ESD-related CEA.

The time allocation to CEA is quite substantial. For instance, at the middle school level, 306 hours out of 3,366 total class hours over three years are prescribed to CEA by the National Curriculum. The ratio of time allocated to CEA to that of what is called ‘Subject Clusters’ is 306 hours vs. 3,060 hours, or 10%.

CEA has provided the greatest opportunities for the curricular implementation of GCED/ESD, although in recent years, more teachers with experience and competence in GCED/ESD tend to integrate it into their regular subject classes, which they perceive to be more effective in terms of learning. Still, with more flexibility and experiential learning activities, CEA continues to provide a fertile ground for the integration of GCED/ESD into the regular curriculum.

The **Exam-Free Semester Policy**, which was implemented in 2016, allows at least one full semester at the lower secondary level, to operate without any exams at all. This exam-free system can now be extended to one year (two full semesters), and according to a survey done in early 2020, over 96% of middle schools across the country have decided to operate one full year of the exam-free system in 2020. This exam-free semester allows teachers to experiment with holistic pedagogy and learning with great flexibility and without being dictated by the assessment system, which is often strictly knowledge-based. Teachers interested and competent in GCED/ESD themes often try out collaborations with fellow teachers to organize cross-subject classes with a range of activities, discussions, and in-depth exploration of themes, which often include students’ action-oriented outputs such as awareness-raising campaigns and place-based projects.

Possibility for Standalone Subject – not mainstreamed, but possible

While there is no subject called ‘global citizenship education’ or ‘education for sustainable development’ in the National Curriculum, there are subject categories called ‘the middle school Elective Subjects

curriculum’ and ‘the high school Life/Liberal Arts curriculum’ under which “schools may offer a new elective or life/liberal arts course, if necessary. In this case, they should take necessary procedures according to the guidelines provided by the Metropolitan and Provincial Office of Education” (Framework 2015). Certain MPOEs might allow schools to set up GCED as one of those subjects. For instance, the Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education has developed a series of textbooks on GCED (2017) together with the Gyeonggi Provincial Office of Education and the Gangwon Provincial Office of Education. The Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education has also provided guidance that allows interested schools to set up GCED as a stand-alone subject in the ‘elective subject group’ at lower secondary level or the ‘life-liberal art subject group’ at the upper secondary level. However, since examples of such cases are rare in the overall education system, this option cannot at present be seen as a means to mainstream GCED/ESD. Additionally, its efficacy has not yet been monitored and needs to be examined in the future.

B1b. Please provide examples of curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents.

2015 Revised National Curriculum

- [Framework](#) * Official English translation is available.

- Syllabi (by subject) * Official English translation is not available.

Social Studies (for primary and lower secondary), Integrated Social Studies (for upper secondary), Korean History, Korean Geography, World Geography, East Asian History, World History, Economics, Politics and Law, Society and Culture, Travel Geography, Social Problem Inquiry (Social Studies), Environment (grades 7-9), Environment (grades 10-12), Moral Life/Inquiring Life/Pleasant Life (an integrated subject for grades 1 and 2), Moral Education (grades 3-6), Moral Education (grades 7-9), Life and Ethics (moral education), Ethics and Ideology (moral education), Classics and Ethics (moral education)

In addition to the explanation above in B1a on how GCED/ESD are mainstreamed in curriculum, **some examples in which GCED/ESD are mainstreamed through the learning content of various subjects** can be observed in the ‘achievement standards’ of certain subjects, which can be seen as learning objectives or expected learning outcomes. Some specific examples are as follows.

<Social Studies (SS) (mandatory for primary and lower secondary) and Integrated Social Studies (ISS) (mandatory for upper secondary)>

* Explanation of the references in square brackets: The **1st number** is the **grade level** (e.g. **6=Grade 6**), the capital letters in the middle represent the subject, and the last numbers indicate lesson units.

[6 SS 07-04] Nurture attitudes that respect different values and cultures through an understanding of human life and its relation to the environment by exploring: regional/local diversity; cultural aspects such as clothing, food, housing of diverse lifestyles; natural factors such as climate and terrain; and other aspects of human life such as religions and traditions.

[6 SS 08-06] Explore challenges in building a sustainable future, such as expansion of environmentally-friendly production, fighting poverty and hunger and malnutrition, and elimination of cultural prejudice and discrimination, and actively participate in seeking solutions to these issues as global citizens.

[10 ISS 04-01] Understand the meaning of human rights, recent citizen revolutions, and changes in human rights over time; research examples of the expansion of human rights into a variety of areas such as housing, safety, and the contemporary environment.

[10 ISS 04-03] Utilize human rights indices presented by international organizations and/or non-governmental organizations to learn about patterns and aspects of human rights-related issues in each region of the world and to explore possible solutions to these issues.

[10 ISS 05-03] Discuss how differences in the regional distribution of resources, labor, capital, and production costs etc. cause international divisions in labor and trade; discuss the positive and negative aspects of the expansion of international trade in the lives of individuals and national economies through examination of specific pertinent examples.

[10 ISS 06-03] Investigate examples of unequal social and spatial phenomena and explore a variety of institutions and practices for creating a just society.

[10 ISS 08-01] Identify the relationship between globalization and localization; determine the aspects of globalization through the formation of global cities and the spatial and economic changes resulting from the emergence of multinational corporations; suggest solutions to the problems resulting from globalization such as destruction of cultural diversity, increased gaps between the poor and the rich, and conflicts between universal norms and locally specific ethics.

[10 ISS 08-02] Through examining various examples of global conflicts and cooperation around the world, locate the autonomous role of governments, international organizations and non-government organizations. To highlight the importance of peace, distinguish negative peace and positive peace.

[10 ISS 08-03] Study the background to the historical conflict in East Asia, the division of North and South Korea, and the necessity of reunification, and search for solutions to these issues. In addition, consider South Korea's global status, historical circumstances, and geographical position, and investigate how the country can contribute to world peace.

<Environmental Education (EE) (for lower secondary, elective)>

[9 EE 02-05] Make a critical inquiry into the social, cultural, and economic aspects of environment issues, in addition to scientific approaches, and propose practices to address environmental problems on a daily basis.

[9 EE 03-07] Through an analysis of cases involving change in the global environment, identify the characteristics of the global environment and global environmental issues. Examine specific examples of global and transnational environmental issues, such as acid rain and desertification, and international conflicts over water and natural resources. Identify the characteristics of a range of global environmental issues, such as their scope, complexity, unequal damage/destruction, differences in urgency, difficulties in reaching agreements for resolution, interdependence, and their varied impacts on the global environment.

[9 EE 03-08] Identify global environmental changes, such as those on rainforests and polar glaciers, and the causes of such changes. Propose solutions at the personal and social levels to preserve the environment.

[9 EE 03-10] Distinguish the causes of climate change and discuss ways to resolve conflicts generated by climate change from the perspectives of members of the global community. Understand that climate change is caused by man-made factors including reckless and excessive use of fossil fuels and excessive development, as well as natural factors such as natural climate patterns that exist. Since climate change is an important challenge that must be addressed by the global community, try to find a solution to the conflicts between those among the global community who have caused the climate change and those who bear an unequal portion of the damage.

[9 EE 03-12] Suggest various measures to respond to climate changes, classifying such measures into those to be taken by individuals and those by societies at the regional, national and global levels. Present your suggestions and relate them to your own personal roles and responsibilities.

[9 EE 04-05]] Examine various environmental issues from the perspective of environmental justice; investigate various ways to participate in making your school, local community, region, and country into sustainable societies.

<World Geography (WG) (for upper secondary, elective)>

[12 WG 08-01] Identify the effects of economic globalization; compare and analyse the background and characteristics of major economic blocs formed by many countries in response to economic globalization.

[12 WG 08-02] Investigate efforts made by international society to cope with global environmental challenges using indicators such as Ecological Footprint and Drought Index; and make suggestions that can be practiced in daily life.

[12 WG 08-03] Examine the major efforts of the global community towards global peace and justice; discuss the desirable values and attitudes of global citizens. (The key learning focus of this chapter is to cultivate knowledge in order to embrace diversity in values and attitudes as global citizens. Therefore, the core of the evaluation is to assess the acquisition of the value of coexistence among humans and with nature, ecological perspectives pursuing sustainability, and cultural knowledge as global citizens.)

<World History (WH) (for upper secondary, elective)>

[12 WH 05-02] Examine the process of how imperialism caused global divisions, leading to World War I and understand this process in relation to the nationalist movements developed in each country; examine how the totalitarianism that emerged after the Great Depression led to World War II. Understand how the experience of the world wars led the international community to make various efforts to prevent the recurrence of war and to realize world peace.

[12 WH 06-02] Understand the changes in modern society brought about by globalization and scientific and technological revolution; develop insights into possible future global developments and an attitude to resolve global conflicts and disputes.

<Politics and Law (PL) (for upper secondary, elective)>

[12 PL 06-01] Understand the changes in current international relations centered around globalization and analyse the meanings and limits of international law as means to solve international conflicts.

[12 PL 06-02] Understand international issues (e.g. relating to security, the economy, the environment, etc.) and analyse the roles and activities carried out by international organizations in order to solve those issues.

<Other Social Studies Subjects (for upper secondary, elective)>

[12 Society and Culture (SC) 05-04] Examine issues around the environment, resources, war, and terrorism, and understand the importance of the concept and practice of global citizenship in tackling such problems.

[12 Inquiries on Social Issues (ISI) 05-01] Understand the meaning of social minorities and discrimination. Investigate various modes of discrimination against social minorities instigated through mass media (TV, movie, advertisements, etc.)

[12 ISI 05-04] Explore social systems and organizations (the national human rights commission; NGOs, etc.) working for minority rights; investigate related jobs.

[12 Travel Geography (TG) 02-03] Understand the value of areas with restrictions on development such as National Monuments, National Parks and the South Pole for the diversity and sustainability of the global environment, and research conflicts between conservation and development and changes in the approach to such conflicts.

Nuri Curriculum (Curriculum for Early Childhood Education. First established in 2012, last revised in 2019) *Official English translation is not available.

It is a relatively recent development that the ROK's Ministry of Education (MOE) has become the central authority in providing the policy framework and operational and curricular guidance for early childhood education. Kindergartens and daycare centres have tended to be considered the realm of childcare rather than early childhood education. The MOE established the first standard national curriculum for early childhood education (Age 3-5), called the 'Nuri Curriculum' in 2012. Since then, it has provided a set of frameworks and parameters for institutionalized early childhood education in South Korea. Unlike the National Curriculum for primary and secondary education, the Nuri Curriculum does not specify learning content. Moreover, unlike the National Curriculum, the document does not explicitly refer to GCED/ESD themes. Instead, the Nuri Curriculum provides a broader set of learning areas and pedagogical approaches through which it emphasizes the value of life – both human and nonhuman – and community, through concepts such as 'living together respectfully with others and in harmony with nature', 'taking an interest in diverse cultures' and 'caring for people and nature'. Each Metropolitan and Provincial Office of Education (MPOE) also has its own early childhood education and promotion centre through which diverse and rich teaching and learning resources and lesson plans are developed based on the Nuri Curriculum and distributed to local kindergartens and daycare centres. Such educational resources and lesson plans cover numerous GCED/ESD themes, including gender equality, anti-discrimination, sustainable consumption, and multiculturalism.

***B2** Please indicate which GCED and ESD themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

***B3** Please indicate in which subjects or fields of study GCED and ESD are taught in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Cultural diversity and tolerance	Gender equality	Human rights	Peace and non-violence	Climate change	Environmental sustainability	Human survival and well-being	Sustainable consumption and production
Arts	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Civics, civil or citizenship education	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Ethics/moral studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Geography	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Health, physical education and sports	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	0
History	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Languages	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Mathematics	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
Religious education*	N/A. In the South Korean National Curriculum, there is no subject called 'religious education.'							
Science	0	0	0	0	1	1	1	1
Social studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Integrated studies	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1
Other (please specify)								
Environment	1	1	1	1	1	1	1	1

* While the National Curriculum does not have ‘religious education’ as a subject area, it allows schools to set up such a course within the middle school Elective Subjects curriculum and the high school Life/Liberal Arts curriculum (Refer to B1a), provided that they abide by proper procedure. If this elective course is taken into account, the response for this table would be ‘9=unknown’, except for cultural diversity and tolerance being ‘1=yes’ (due to the guidelines given by the National Curriculum. See B1a.) since no particular textbook or lesson plans are currently available or accessible for review.

***B4** Please indicate the approaches used to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)*	0*
Cross-curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

* Refer to B1a for the explanation on how GCED can be set up as a stand-alone subject, even though the National Curriculum does not include GCED as a separate subject specifically. The cases of this being done are so rare that ‘0’ has been entered, although such cases are not non-existent.

B5 Please indicate which human rights education themes are taught as part of the curriculum at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
3. Human rights education				
3.1 equality and non-discrimination based on race, colour, language, religion, disability, political or other opinion, national or social origin, birth or other status	1	1	1	1
3.2 human rights values, human dignity, justice, inclusion and participation	1	1	1	1
3.3 respect for human rights and fundamental freedoms (as outlined in international conventions and declarations)	1	1	1	1

C. Teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) (paras 4 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

C1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are mainstreamed in initial training and in continuing professional development of teachers, trainers and educators. Indicate whether all teachers, trainers and educators or only some are required to receive training to teach GCED and/or ESD.

Since the World Education Forum in Incheon, Republic of Korea, in 2015, GCED/ESD has emerged as a major education agenda in South Korea. The Ministry of Education (MOE), encouraged by SDG 4.7 and the country's growing role and responsibility in the global community, and the majority of the Metropolitan Offices of Education (MPOEs), not only inspired by SDG 4.7 but also – and more importantly – by their long-standing commitment to transformative education, have found GCED/ESD to be very timely and much needed. In this context, the central and local governments' support for teacher education on GCED/ESD related themes, particularly in-service training, has been increasing, most visibly in terms of teacher training programmes. Pre-service teacher education is the province of Teacher Education Institutes (TEIs), which have a high level of autonomy in terms of the curriculum they offer, although the teaching credentials they award are subject to strict quality assessment by the MOE. As a result, the modality of governmental support to TEIs for GCED/ESD is different from the support for in-service teacher training. TEIs tend to set their own agendas and curricular foci reflecting the demands and needs of their students, academia, and society. Nonetheless, what is common between government support for GCED/ESD in pre-service and in-service teacher education is that the MOE and MPOEs (for K-12), and the MOE (for TEIs), have invested budget in recent years to create a diverse range of programmes to enhance teacher capacities in GCED/ESD.

The increasing popularity of GCED/ESD in the pre-service curricula of TEIs has been noted in a recent analysis of the TEIs' curricula (APCEIU, 2020. Refer to **H** on research), which extensively reviewed the curricula of the 13 TEIs for primary level and 46 TEIs for secondary level. Although the proportion of GCED/ESD-related courses to the entire set of non-major courses may vary greatly among universities, it was found that 137 GCED/ESD-related courses (11.5%) out of 1,196 sets of non-major courses are run by the 13 TEIs for primary level, and 847 GCED/ESD-related courses (6.9%) out of 12,212 sets of non-major courses are organized by the 46 TEIs for secondary level. Among those GCED/ESD-related courses, the highest proportion is occupied by those that directly address issues of sustainable development.

The MOE has also been committed to supporting various GCED/ESD-related course development projects at the university level. A number of TEIs have been involved in such projects, although some of those projects do not necessarily put GCED/ESD capacity building as their primary goal. Examples include the MOE-sponsored Projects on Capacity-Building for Citizenship Education at TEIs, and Global Teacher's University (GTU) Project. The former aim to build pre-service teachers' capacities for citizenship education through improvements to TEIs' citizenship education curricula, development of pedagogies for citizenship education, and promotion of best practices. Even though the projects overarching theme is citizenship education, GCED is also covered. For implementation on the ground, such projects often recruit teacher educators and academics with strong commitment to and/or expertise in GCED for their project teams. The MOE's GTU Project also aims to equip pre-service teachers with global competencies and cultural literacy, and works in partnership with foreign universities. The project's content relating to GCED is often integrated into activities such as co-teaching programmes and training workshops.

The MOE also sponsors an APCEIU programme that is clearly articulated as a GCED project. Through this project, roughly translated as 'Support for GCED Course Development in Higher Education Institutions,' APCEIU has supported the development of 42 GCED courses at 22 universities, over a half of which are TEIs. APCEIU also provides training workshops and consultations for educators at selected universities and organizes an annual workshop for sharing the outcomes of GCED courses. Another programme dealing with GCED in higher education (including TEIs) is the Development Awareness Program, run by the Korea International Cooperation Agency (KOICA) under the Ministry of Foreign Affairs. This project aims to raise students' awareness of international development and cooperation from the perspective of GCED and the SDGs in general. To this end, it supports the development of relevant courses and facilitates on-site

activities both within South Korea and abroad. Collectively, the MOE's GTU project, the APCEIU project and the KOICA project have together supported the capacity-building of 70 TEIs in GCED/ESD during the years 2018-2020. (APCEIU, 2020)

For in-service training, the 17 MPOEs are the key providers/actors. GCED policies comprise 12% of the total policies of the 17 MPOEs. Among the GCED policies, teacher training programmes comprise 10.2% of the total, while programmes to support teaching and learning of GCED make up 64%, and curriculum development programmes make up 8.9% (APCEIU, 2019). The MPOEs also tend to collaborate with each other. One example is the joint project for the development of GCED textbooks in 2017. Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education, Incheon Metropolitan City Office of Education, Gyeonggido Office of Education, and Gangwon Provincial Office of Education jointly developed GCED textbooks for primary and secondary teachers. The four offices recognized the necessity of the GCED textbooks for teachers' educational activities and teacher training as teachers and teacher trainers had difficulty implementing GCED in their educational settings because a lot of GCED-related content was spread amongst numerous subjects, such as civic education, arts education, and social studies. The MPOEs agreed to develop GCED textbooks to cover climate change, war and peace, human rights, equity, and cultural diversity, thereby enabling teachers and teacher trainers to design GCED curricula inside and outside of the classroom. Officially authorized by the Gyeonggido Office of Education, these textbooks have been widely utilized by teachers and teacher trainers within the country.

The MOE also cooperates with the 17 MPOEs on GCED teacher education for in-service teachers. One example is APCEIU's GCED Lead Teachers Program sponsored by the MOE since 2015. To implement a more democratic, transformative and sustainable education, the programme offers teacher-centred research and continuous capacity-building opportunities for Korean teachers to enhance their capacities in carrying out GCED teaching and increase their research abilities to identify various GCED practices. Each year, four national GCED lead teachers from each MPOE are trained by APCEIU and the MOE. They implement various GCED activities such as developing learners' GCED knowledge, skills, values and attitudes in their educational settings, and developing GCED teaching and learning materials. GCED lead teachers also organize GCED study associations in their provinces, hold special lectures, and research GCED-related issues and pedagogies, with the help of each MPOE. The national lead teachers also train provincial lead teachers of GCED in their provinces annually, in cooperation with the 17 MPOEs. The total number of national and provincial lead teachers trained since 2015 is approximately 4,000 so far. The GCED lead teachers programme runs on an application basis, not on a mandatory basis.

The ROK Government also provides online teacher training on GCED through KOICA and APCEIU. In particular, the government has provided support for APCEIU to manage the [GCED Online Campus](#), which targets educators, youth, and the general public both within South Korea and abroad. since 2016. The campus collaborates with the Ban Ki-moon Centre for Global Citizens (BKMC) in Vienna, to provide E-learning programmes that focus on fostering global citizenship and gender equality to achieve the SDGs. It has open courses and advanced courses that give an overview of GCED, and cover pedagogies, best practices, advocacy, curriculum development, and topics relating to GCED, as well as general and special lectures on the thematic area of GCED. APCEIU has also collaborated with the private education company I-Scream Media on a Public-Private Partnership (PPP) to develop a GCED course for Korean teachers. The course was launched in 2020 and contains 30 lectures on subjects such as the SDGs, the GCED concept, transformative pedagogies, GCED implementation in and outside the classroom, thematic areas of GCED, development of GCED action plans, etc. Most of the GCED lead teachers and teachers interested in GCED in South Korea are taking this course and utilizing the lessons for their educational activities.

KOICA is also pursuing a PPP on GCED in cooperation with I-Scream Media, offering yet another GCED course for Korean educators. This course consists of 30 lectures covering global issues, Official Development Aid (ODA), GCED practices in The Republic of Korea and abroad, and GCED pedagogies, etc. The course emphasizes that GCED issues are closely related to international development and cooperation issues, and to ODA.

Last but not least, a range of civil society organizations in South Korea, such as PEACEMOMO, Beautiful Store, Amnesty International Korea, Good Neighbours, and World Vision also carry out GCED-related activities, including teacher education for pre- and in-service teachers and civic educators. For example,

PEACEMOMO, which specializes in peace education, has organized various workshops to support school teachers, civic educators and teacher trainers in the subjects of peace education and GCED. World Vision has implemented a nationwide ‘Schools of Global Citizenship’ project in which the organization collaborated with 489 South Korean schools to organize GCED-related activities, including teacher training workshops for GCED twice a year and GCED online workshops on peace, human rights, and the environment. Good Neighbours, which organizes various GCED-related projects, has run teacher training workshops on human rights, including children’s rights, for pre-primary school teachers, primary and secondary teachers, and civic educators. Beautiful Store mainly focuses on fostering responsible consumer behaviour and global citizenship by highlighting fair trade and environmental protection.

C1b. Please provide examples of teacher training policies or curricula in which GCED and/or ESD are mainstreamed and, where possible, web links to relevant documents. If possible, include examples related to initial training and to continuing professional development.

English versions of the documents listed below are not available

- Annual Plan for Education (MOE)
- Annual Plans for Education (each MPOE)
- [Basic Plan for Peace and Global Citizenship Education](#)
- Annual Plan for the GCED Lead Teachers Programme (MOE, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020)
- [GCED Online Campus](#)
- [GCED online courses by APCEIU and I-scream Media](#)
- [GCED online courses by KOICA and I-scream Media](#)

< Example #1. Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education >

A series of GCED plans by the Seoul Metropolitan Office of Education (SMOE) have been merged into the Basic Plan for Peace and Global Citizenship Education in 2020. Given the significant role of peace education and GCED in creating a more peaceful and sustainable world, the SMOE has designed the Basic Plan so that it can pursue synergy between peace and global citizenship education. The plan encompasses the following comprehensive priorities for peace education and GCED, with policy and the curriculum for teacher education integrated throughout those areas: i) Supporting primary and secondary schools in Seoul in order for them to implement peace education and GCED in their educational settings; ii) Developing peace education and GCED programmes and; iii) Promoting peace education and GCED and establishing networks among related organizations.

i) Supporting Schools to Implement Peace Education and GCED

- Integration of Peace Education and GCED into School Plans: The SMOE aims to enable primary and secondary schools in Seoul to integrate peace education and GCED into their school plans and curriculum. To this end, the SMOE encourages schools to establish a curriculum committee to act as the focal point in each school for connecting peace education to GCED and to develop the overall plan and curriculum for it, including the curriculum for teacher training on peace education and GCED. The SMOE also supports the establishment of a pool of resource persons for peace education and GCED.
- Operation of Special Support for Peace Education and GCED: The SMOE also provides schools with advice on training programmes and information on teacher training in organizations related to peace education and GCED.
- Supporting UNESCO Associated Schools Network (ASPnet) Schools: In order to promote UNESCO’s educational agenda and activities, the SMOE encourages schools to build networks under the ASPnet and helps them to develop various peace education and GCED programmes that reflect local contexts, as well as giving teachers information on teacher training and workshops.

ii) Developing Peace Education and GCED Programmes

- Development and Dissemination of Teaching and Learning Materials for Peace Education and GCED: The SMOE supports primary and secondary teachers by providing them with teaching and learning materials on how to establish a GCED-friendly atmosphere in their schools and

how to teach the content of peace education and GCED in their classroom. In addition, the SMOE is developing teachers' guides for use in every subject, not only in social studies or civic education. Two types of teaching and learning materials on peace education and one guidebook for GCED in civic education are under development in 2020.

- Research on GCED: The SMOE has carried out research on its achievements regarding GCED activities and the establishment of a monitoring system in Seoul. From this research it has derived recommendations for the improvement of GCED implementation in Seoul, including suggestions for teacher education.

iii) Promoting Peace Education and GCED and Establishing Networks

- Management of Teacher Training on Peace Education and GCED: In partnership with GCED-related organizations such as APCEIU, the SMOE provides customized teacher training and workshops on peace education and GCED for teachers in Seoul. These trainings and workshops have become a significant platform for peace education and GCED by developing a training curriculum to integrate peace education into GCED, sharing best practices with teachers and offering online workshops on GCED, etc. The SMOE previously tended to treat peace education and GCED separately in its teacher education, but recognizing the synergy between peace education and GCED, has integrated peace education into GCED in the area of teacher education since 2020.

As the office of education for the capital of the Republic of Korea, the SMOE acts as a role model for other MPOEs in carrying out various GCED activities and projects that support teachers to implement GCED in their local context, and in developing GCED policy and curricula in the area of teacher education.

< Example #2. Daejeon Metropolitan Office of Education >

The Daejeon Metropolitan Office of Education organized a GCED lead teachers' study association in 2020 under the overarching theme of GCED in the Era of the Pandemic. In consultation with APCEIU and the Daejeon Metropolitan Office of Education, the lead teachers in Daejeon set the following 4 priority areas for GCED, summarized as 'POST'.

- **Programme (P)**: Development of GCED programmes to prepare for a new normal. Programmes should cover GCED topics and learning objectives recommended by UNESCO, to connect formal education to non/informal education, and to develop GCED content for online lectures.
- **Opportunity (O)**: Provision of many opportunities for capacity building for teachers and learners, by organizing GCED reading clubs for teachers and students and implementing GCED workshops and seminars.
- **System (S)**: Establishment of a diversified system for GCED implementation in the era of the pandemic – creating a variety of platforms, including regular/irregular on/offline consultation meetings, and utilizing APCEIU's GCED online campus to develop modules for on/offline classes, etc.
- **Target (T)**: Targeting various actors, including teachers, students, parents, and other members of the local community for the promotion of GCED in Daejeon.

The study association consists of 4 departments: Management, Research, Promotion, and Development. The departments have carried out various GCED activities, including holding GCED workshops and seminars, developing on/offline programmes, promoting GCED through social networking services, and publishing and disseminating GCED teaching and learning materials.

*C2 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach GCED and ESD during initial or pre-service training and/or through continuing professional development. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Initial or pre-service training				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	1	1
Continuing professional development				
For teachers of selected subjects only (in which GCED or ESD are typically taught)	1	1	1	1
For teachers of other subjects	1	1	1	1

*C3 Please indicate on which GCED and ESD themes pre-service or in-service training is available for teachers, trainers and educators at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*C4 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to teach the following dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

*C5 Please indicate whether teachers, trainers and educators are trained to use the following approaches to teach GCED and ESD in primary and secondary education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Global citizenship and education for sustainable development
GCED/ESD are taught as separate subject(s)	1
Cross curriculum approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught in more than one subject but not throughout the curriculum)	1
Integrated approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are taught throughout the whole curriculum)	1
Whole school approach (e.g. GCED/ESD are integrated in the school ethos, management, governance, curriculum, teacher training, teaching practices, the learning environment, and in learning experiences in the community and life outside school)	1

D. Student assessment (paras 4 and 5 of the 1974 Recommendation)

D1a. Please describe in which ways GCED and ESD are covered in student assessments and examinations. Indicate whether students are assessed only on their knowledge of and skills related to the topics being tested or also on their values, attitudes and/or behaviours.

Since students' learning is expected to be assessed strictly based on achievement standards, the parts of the achievement standards that include GCED/ESD will be included in assessments/examinations. The student assessments can be summative or formative, or usually a combination of both. The lower the grade level, the more formative their assessments tend to be. It is also an overall trend for more formative assessments to have been introduced in recent years.

Since student assessments are supposed to be based on the expected learning outcomes that achievement standards specify in the subject-specific National Curriculum, the assessment of GCED/ESD includes not only **knowledge (k)** but also **values (v)**, **attitudes (a)** and **behaviors (b)**, just as in the achievement standards that include all the dimensions of learning. Examples are as follows, some of which were also presented in the previous section, **B1**.

[6 ME (Moral Education) 03-04]] Discuss the problems that human beings face in the era of globalization and their root causes; develop the willingness to solve such problems and act upon it. 1) What are the various problems of the global community that we experience, and how can we raise moral sensitivity towards such global issues? 2) What are ways to solve such global issues and how can we make the right decisions to solve them? (**k, b, v, a**)

[9 ME 03-01] Understand that human dignity, human rights, and gender equality are universal values from a moral standpoint; be able to empathize with and care about others, based on due respect for their human rights and resistance against various forms of social prejudices. 1) Why are human dignity and human rights important? 2) How do we treat social minorities? 3) How do we promote gender equality? (**k, b, a**)

[9 ME 03-03] Cultivate the ethics of a global citizen by understanding moral values/ethics required for global citizens, recognizing various moral issues arising in the global community and developing a pro-active attitude to participation in solving such problems. 1) Am I global citizen? 2) What are the ethical/moral issues that global citizens face? 3. How can we solve these ethical/moral issues? (**k,b,a**)

[9 ME 04-01] Understand the importance to human life of humanity living in harmony with nature; understand the need for the protection of the environment from various perspectives. Evaluate the impact of human consumption patterns on the environment from the point of view of ecological sustainability; acquire practical environmentally-friendly life skills. 1. Are human beings the master of

nature? 2. What are the connections between environmental values and consumption patterns? 3. What concrete action can be taken for an eco-friendly life? **(k, b, v, a)**

[6 SS (Social Studies) 07-04] Nurture attitudes that respect different values and cultures through an understanding of human life and its relation to the environment by exploring: regional/local diversity; cultural aspects such as clothing, food, and housing of diverse lifestyles; natural factors such as climate and terrain; and other aspects of human life such as religions and traditions. **(k, b, v)**

[6 SS 08-06] Explore challenges in building a sustainable future, such as expansion of environmentally-friendly production, fighting poverty and hunger and malnutrition, and elimination of cultural prejudice and discrimination; actively participate in seeking solutions to these issues as global citizens. **(k, b, v)**

[9 EE (Environmental Education) 03-12] Suggest various measures to respond to climate changes by classifying such measures into those to be taken by individuals and those to be taken by societies at regional, national and global levels; present your suggestions and relate them to your own personal roles and responsibilities. **(k, b, v, a)**

[9 EE 04-05]] Examine various environmental issues from the perspective of environmental justice; investigate various ways to participate in making (your) school, local community, region, and country into sustainable societies. **(k, b, v)**

[10 ISS (Integrated Social Studies) 04-01] Understand the meaning of human rights, recent citizen revolutions, and changes in human rights over time; research examples of the expansion of human rights into a variety of areas such as housing, safety, and the contemporary environment. **(k, b)**

[10 ISS 04-03] Utilize human rights indices presented by international organizations and/or non-governmental organizations to learn about patterns and aspects of human rights-related issues in each region of the world and to explore possible solutions to these issues. **(k, b, v)**

[10 ISS 05-03] Discuss how differences in the regional distribution of resources, labor, capital, and production costs etc. cause international divisions in labor and trade; and discuss the positive and negative aspects of the expansion of international trade in the lives of individuals and the national economy through examination of specific pertinent examples. **(k, b)**

[10 ISS 06-03] Investigate examples of unequal social and spatial phenomena and explore a variety of institutions and practices for creating a just society. **(k, b)**

[12 Life and Ethics (LE) 05-03] Develop an understanding of the characteristics of multicultural society, an attitude of tolerance based on a mature sense of citizenship, and an appropriate cultural identity. **(k, b, v, a)**

[12 LE 06-03] Critically analyse a variety of international disputes and inequalities between countries (poverty, gaps between the wealthy and the poor, unequal distribution of resources etc.) from moral/ethical perspectives; understand global responsibilities for and contributions to these issues; propose concrete examples of solutions. **(k, b, v, a)**

*D2 Please indicate whether the GCED and ESD themes below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education**
1. Cultural diversity and tolerance	1	1	1	1
2. Gender equality	1	1	1	1
3. Human rights	1	1	1	1
4. Peace and non-violence	1	1	1	1
5. Climate change	1	1	1	1
6. Environmental sustainability	1	1	1	1
7. Human survival and well-being	1	1	1	1
8. Sustainable consumption and production	1	1	1	1

*D3 Please indicate which of the dimensions of learning in GCED and ESD below are generally included in student assessments or examinations at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education**
Knowledge	1	1	1	1
Skills	1	1	1	1
Values	1	1	1	1
Attitudes and behaviours	1	1	1	1

* As the National Curriculum in the Republic of Korea is organized through a competence-based approach or learning outcome-based approach, the learning objectives and assessment criteria both naturally reflect all those aforementioned dimensions. The competence-based learning is also the approach taken in tertiary and non-formal education.

** For the aforementioned reason, “1” has been put also for non-formal education, on the understanding that “student assessments” can be interpreted in a broad sense as “evaluation of learners”. However, if the question is strictly about formal student assessment or examination, the column for non-formal education should be marked “Not Applicable”.

E. Mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment (paras 4-5, 7, 10-19 and 33-37 of the 1974 Recommendation)

*E1 Based on your responses to questions in the previous four sections (laws and policies, curricula, teacher education and student assessment) please indicate to what extent global citizenship education (GCED) and education for sustainable development (ESD) are mainstreamed⁵ in (a) education laws and policies, (b) curricula (c) teacher education (including the training of trainers and educators) and (d) student assessment in your country. Please enter the appropriate number in each white cell in the table below.

KEY:

0 Not at all

GCED and ESD are not mainstreamed.

1 Partially

Some GCED and/or ESD themes⁶ are mainstreamed. Select this option if GCED is mainstreamed but ESD is not (or vice versa).

2 Extensively

Most GCED and ESD themes are mainstreamed.

9 Not known

It is not known whether GCED and ESD are mainstreamed or not.

99 Not applicable

The given level of government does not have responsibility for the given component (policies, curricula, teacher education or student assessment) and/or does not have responsibility for the given level or type of education. This may occur at the national level in federal countries where education is the responsibility of individual states or at the sub-national level in small countries where there is only one level of government.

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
National				
(a) Education laws and policies	2	2	2	1
(b) Curricula	1	2	99	1
(c) Teacher education	1	2	2	2
(d) Student assessment	99	1*	2	99
Sub-national				
(a) Education laws and policies	99	2	99	1
(b) Curricula	99	2	99	1
(c) Teacher education	1	2	2	2
(d) Student assessment	99	1*	2	99

* Although the student assessment criteria reflect the learning objectives of the national curriculum for primary and secondary education, it can be said that GCED/ESD may be less mainstreamed in terms of assessment than in the curriculum itself since implementation of student assessment still mainly relies on a subject-specific, summative, and knowledge-based approach rather than the learning objectives of the curriculum, which are prescribed heavily in terms of competence-based and holistic frameworks.

⁵ GCED and ESD are mainstreamed if their themes are mentioned explicitly in relevant documents and are expected to be implemented by the relevant authorities (e.g. Ministries, regional or local education authorities), educational institutions (e.g. schools, colleges and universities) and/or education professionals (e.g. teachers, lecturers, trainers and educators) as appropriate.

⁶ Refer to the schema in paragraph 11 of Section II of these guidelines.

F. Technical and vocational education and training (paras 25-29 of the 1974 *Recommendation*)

- F1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in technical and vocational education and training. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

TVET in South Korea is part of formal education at the upper secondary level. Middle schools may use the school hours allocated to 'Creative Experiential Activities' or 'Exam-Free Semesters' to allow students to explore available career choices or obtain job-related hands-on experiences. However, these programmes can be considered more as initial career counselling than TVET. The two-year technical colleges in South Korea are also considered to belong to both higher education and TVET. This response focuses on TVET only at the high school level.

Since technical high schools also share some common curriculum with other high schools, GCED/ESD themes are often introduced as cross-cutting themes in the curriculum. However, interest from the TVET field in GCED/ESD themes is shaped by the particular needs of TVET and may centre around a few particular thematic areas.

One noticeable initiative is a recent effort to increase and enhance human rights education relevant to students in TVET, who are prospective workers but also engaged in various apprenticeship programmes. As noted above in B1, the Ministry of Education has established a Plan for the Promotion of Labor-related Human Rights Education to enhance students' awareness of legal and ethical dimensions of human rights and their competencies to deal with any infringement on human rights or discriminatory situations. Some experts and teachers, however, also point out the shortcoming in this promotion of human rights and human rights education by indicating that students also need to learn to reflect on their own prejudices and actions to prevent themselves from infringing upon the rights of others. This is particularly important in rapidly changing work environments, especially those of manufacturing, where students in TVET are more likely to encounter linguistic, ethnic and cultural diversity. Hence, it has been suggested that education for anti-discrimination, social justice, and international understanding should be strengthened particularly in TVET, with more life-relevant content, methods, and materials.

Global competencies, including intercultural literacy, is another area in which technical high schools have an interest. The MOE and MPOEs provide some exchange programmes to enhance global competencies and intercultural literacy. APCEIU, with the support of the MOE and MPOEs, has also operated international teacher exchange programmes in TVET for many years.

Another area of interest to technical high schools is the issue of changing environments and sustainable development, particularly in relation to safety, technology, and changing industries. With increasing awareness given to this area, vocational schools are now trying to eliminate any toxic materials and instead use environmentally-friendly materials to support student training. This also entails educating students about environmentally safe and sustainable materials. Environmental sustainability and environmentally-friendly technologies are found more often today within school curricula and teaching content.

G. Adult education (para 30 of the 1974 *Recommendation*)

- G1 Please describe any major initiatives that have been undertaken to promote GCED and/or ESD in adult education and other forms of non-formal education including youth education, out-of-school education, etc. Describe briefly the outcomes and impact of such initiatives and provide examples of good practices.

South Korea's current lifelong education system, including adult education, stems from the country's 1999 Lifelong Education Act. The Act triggered a state-led structuring of adult learning that trickles down from the national level (e.g. development of frameworks and guidelines) to the regional and local levels (e.g. management of networks of adult learning providers and promotion of the usage of underutilized public

spaces as learning spaces). Furthermore, the Act specified that lifelong educators should receive professional training and placements.

As the legal basis for adult education in the ROK, the Act brought transformations in the 1990s, with education in general, including adult learning education, reflecting a growing discourse related to the environment, working women, human rights, unification and welfare. Citizenship education helped address local and environmental matters, supported marginalized women's voices to be heard, and brought consumer-related issues to greater prominence. Interest in GCED in South Korea has been growing particularly since globalization. However, GCED has a relatively short history in the country and still lacks the recognition and consensus needed to establish its position in the education sector. There have been delays in enacting GCED-related legislation, and a complete survey of national statistics in this area has yet to be carried out.

In this context, GCED in adult learning in South Korea has been implemented mainly by civil society. A number of NGOs in peace education, human rights education, environmental education, and international development education have been organizing GCED activities, such as teacher training and development of GCED materials, through various means (e.g. art, GCED-related documents, ICT, the whole-school approach, and transformative pedagogies) for practitioners and educators in adult education. For instance, some NGOs in peace education provide their own training of trainers (ToT) programmes designed for school teachers and civic educators, while others run environmental campaigns and workshops for teachers and teacher trainers in partnership with local communities and schools.

Meanwhile, GCED in adult education has also been carried out at the local government level, albeit sporadically. For example, Seoul's Metropolitan Institute for Lifelong Learning has developed an Educational Design Toolkit that aims to increase the capacities of adult learning educators to foster GCED in lifelong learning. The toolkit promotes active learning in adult learning by enabling educators and learners to build programme content together in order to enhance the relevance of learning. It consists of a user manual and a set of cards to help construct objectives, learning targets, activities, etc., that can be configured step by step, and has multiple pedagogical applications. For instance users can restructure their knowledge and experience through participatory workshops, and educators and learners can apply civic education practices when designing their programmes.

Against this backdrop, APCEIU has led some significant work in 2019 and 2020 to consolidate the GCED actions of lifelong learning centres run by different local governments in South Korea. First, APCEIU implemented a situational analysis of GCED in adult learning in South Korea in 2019. The research analysed the programmes of 475 lifelong learning centres through surveys and interviews. It concluded that GCED has yet to be mainstreamed in the area of adult learning: i) Compared to the formal education sector, GCED policy and programmes are not sufficient to meet the demand of the public; ii) GCED capacity building for practitioners is a priority for adult learning in the Republic of Korea; iii) The content of civic education conducted by lifelong learning centres needs to be expanded to include GCED and; iv) The ambiguity of the concept of GCED is a stumbling block in implementing GCED programmes. Given the research results, the necessity of qualified educators to carry out GCED in adult education is recognized.

As part of the ROK Government response, APCEIU, the National Institute for Lifelong Education, Seoul National University, and Yeosu City jointly organized the first GCED Workshop for experts from public lifelong learning centres in South Korea in November of 2020. The selected practitioners from lifelong learning centres nationwide participated in an online preparatory workshop that dealt with the understanding of GCED in the UNESCO context, implementing GCED in the formal educational settings, and integrating GCED into adult learning in South Korea. Following the online workshop, the participants also joined an advanced offline workshop to discuss the practice of GCED in adult learning, develop action plans for the implementation of GCED, and build a network among the participants. Through lectures, discussions, and presentations, the participants identified the challenges and opportunities for GCED in their own context, and developed their centres' GCED action plans. After the first workshop, a robust network has been established, and it is planned to expand this network year by year, with the joint workshop expected to serve as a cornerstone for the integration of GCED into adult learning in South Korea.

H. Research and International Co-operation (paras 41-45 of the 1974 Recommendation)

H1 Please describe what kinds of research or experimentation have been carried out to improve the implementation of GCED and/or ESD. Describe briefly how the results of such activities have influenced education policies, curricula and/or teaching practices.

[Research]

Research on GCED/ESD has been carried out by a number of stakeholders. Some national institutes and expert groups affiliated with, or requested by, the MOE and the MPOEs have been conducting policy studies on GCED/ESD and their related themes. These studies are often completed to assess the feasibility and strategies of certain policies that the MOE or the MPOEs might be planning. Policy studies on education for democratic citizenship, multiculturalism, and ecological transition, for example, are among these policy-oriented research programmes. Recently, APCEIU launched a series of studies on peace education in/for South Korea in 2020, and will hopefully conduct similar studies in/for Northeast Asia in the coming years. These studies take the multi-dimensional, holistic approach of UNESCO's peace education as a set of parameters for education ideally to pursue. The research results are intended to be shared with policymakers at the national and provincial levels so that a holistic vision of peace education can be integrated into core policies, including the national curriculum expected to be revised in 2022.

In recent years, there has also been a growing interest in the monitoring of GCED/ESD. Several MPOEs have conducted research to monitor their own programmes, for instance. At the national level, APCEIU has conducted a series of situational analyses and research for monitoring. As a UNESCO Category 2 Centre specialized in GCED, APCEIU was also requested to be the focal point for SDG 4.7 in South Korea, where it is hosted. In this context, APCEIU has continued its efforts to contribute to the establishment of the monitoring system for 4.7 in South Korea. It has conducted a number of situational analyses of GCED in the curriculum, in K-12 in general and in the field of lifelong learning, as well as studies on monitoring systems and indicators. Examples of these analyses include *A Study on the Development of Indicators and Monitoring Framework for GCED in South Korea* (2019) and *A Study on the Monitoring Framework of GCED in South Korea* (2020). The studies are part of a series of recent efforts to develop a monitoring system in South Korea that can both align itself with the global indicator SDG 4.7.1 and reflect the domestic context and feasibility. Based on this research, a set of more refined and specific indicators have been suggested to the Commission for the K-SDGs as domestic indicators, although the development of a feasible and efficient system to collect data utilizing those indicators and tools remains a task to be pursued in the upcoming years. Further thematic indicators that include qualitative data also need to be developed in the coming years to illuminate the processes, challenges and possibilities for GCED/ESD so that meaningful interventions in policy and practice can be proposed.

Other research includes studies of issue-based approaches and a number of small-scale, practice-oriented research studies conducted by teachers and practitioners to further develop pedagogies and teaching-learning materials and resources. The MPOEs often support teachers in their research activities while the MOE, through APCEIU, also supports research groups organized by some active GCED Lead Teachers. The emerging themes in this year of the COVID pandemic are GCED in times of crisis and for the vision of a post-pandemic world. In this vein, a number of research studies have been conducted to re-articulate the importance and role of GCED in relation to the issues that have arisen or intensified during the pandemic, such as new and old forms of discrimination, problems of the infodemic age, the importance of media literacy, the defense and rethinking of democracy, notions of the commons, and the need to transform human relationships with ecology. Such issue-based research studies have been conducted both by scholars, for the reconceptualization of research, and by teachers, for the basis from which to develop teaching materials and methods.

[International Cooperation]

With regard to international cooperation, the Republic of Korea is focusing its efforts on capacity building, partnership and information sharing to support the realization of ESD/GCED on the national, regional and global levels.

To promote multilateral collaboration and strengthen the leadership of GCED implementation at the UN level, the Government of the Republic of Korea, through APCEIU, has been conducting the UN GCED Seminar since 2015, targeting the permanent delegations and other relevant stakeholders at the UN. The Republic of Korea has also been highly committed to organizing GCED High-Level Events for education ministers and other senior-level officials from the UNESCO Member States, to provide a medium for discussion on global competence and global citizenship through education. In 2020, the ROK Government, through the Permanent Delegation of the Republic of Korea to UNESCO, has collaborated with UNESCO Headquarters and APCEIU in organizing Virtual GCED Talks with UNESCO Chairs on ‘Rethinking GCED and Future of Education’. Six distinguished UNESCO Chairs and professors in areas related to GCED were invited to discuss the current state of the education process at tertiary level and the roles of GCED that should be considered by the UNESCO Member States in addressing the various problems that have arisen or worsened amid the pandemic. A virtual workshop on GCED with experts and practitioners in the fields of GCED policy development, curriculum development, teacher training and youth leadership, has also been conducted to enhance understanding of GCED among the Permanent Delegations of the Group of Friends for Solidarity and Inclusion with GCED Member States.

The ROK Government has also striven to enhance understanding of GCED among a wider audience. In particular, the Ministry of Education has been cooperating with the Ministry of Foreign Affairs, UNESCO Headquarters and APCEIU in organizing the International Conference on GCED since 2016. The conference serves as a platform to share pedagogy and practices in GCED with participants from various backgrounds, including GCED specialized institutes, GCED experts and practitioners, education policymakers and representatives of international organizations, from all around the world. The 5th International Conference on GCED was held successfully through virtual platforms in November 2020 under the theme ‘Fostering Solidarity and Hope through GCED.’

With the support of APCEIU, the Republic of Korea has been working closely with UNESCO to provide a series of initiatives to bring GCED stakeholders (e.g. education authorities, teaching professionals, research institutes) together since 2013. In particular, since 2017, the South Korean Government has provided support to APCEIU to jumpstart the formation and activities of regional GCED networks in five regions, the Arab States, Asia-Pacific, Europe and North America, Latin America and the Caribbean, and Sub-Saharan Africa. This year’s supported activities include GCED MOOC Development targeting youths in Latin America and the Caribbean, GCED material development for Asia and the Pacific, a GCED curriculum desk review and GCED integration roadmap for the Sub-Saharan Africa region, GCED curriculum development in the Arab States region, and a research project to strengthen the Europe and North America Regional GCED Network.

On the global level, the Republic of Korea has been working with UNESCO Headquarters and APCEIU to initiate the Annual Meeting of the GCED Actors’ Platform as an effort to gather regional coordinators and partners working on GCED and provide a discussion platform to coordinate activities and enhance synergies. The inaugural meeting of the platform was held in Seoul in September 2019 with a focus on GCED capacity building for teachers/educators, and the second meeting was conducted virtually in November 2020 on the topic of GCED research.

In recognition of its increasing role within the global community as well as its own rapid demographic and societal changes, the Republic of Korea has remained committed to supporting APCEIU in implementing the Asia-Pacific Teacher Exchange for Global Education Programme (APTE) since 2012. The programme aims to enhance participating teachers’ competencies in global education and GCED, strengthen the global competencies and intercultural literacy of students and members of participating schools, and reinforce the foundation for exchanges among schools and teachers, particularly in the Asia-Pacific region. Back in 2012, the programme began with South Korea and two partner countries in Asia, Mongolia and the Philippines. Since then, the programme has grown significantly - nine countries, including South Korea, have joined APTE and around 180 teachers participate in the programme each year. In 2020, although the onsite teacher exchange programme was suspended as a result of COVID-19, the Republic of Korea cooperated with Cambodia, Indonesia, Laos, Malaysia, Mongolia, Thailand, and the Philippines to strengthen online exchange and content development.

H2 Please indicate which types of activities are available that promote international co-operation at each level of education by entering the appropriate number in each white cell.

KEY: 0 = no, 1 = yes, 9 = unknown

	Pre-primary	Primary and secondary	Tertiary	Non-formal education
Hosting of international meetings on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	1	1
Participation in international meetings abroad on GCED and/or ESD	9	1	1	1
Support for programmes hosting foreign students, researchers and/or teachers	1	1	1	1
Membership of international networks including ASPnet	1	1	1	1
Joint research projects on GCED and/or ESD with foreign institutions	9	1	1	1
Other activities (please specify):		International Teacher Exchange Programme* (sponsored by the ROK MOE, organized by APCEIU, in cooperation with the MOEs of the partner countries)		GCED Actor's Platform, Global and Regional GCED Networks, International Conference on GCED, etc. (initiated by APCEIU)

* Sponsored by the ROK MOE and organized by APCEIU, in cooperation with the MOEs of 7 partner countries. Approx. 200 teachers annually from 8 participating countries, including South Korea, are provided opportunities to teach, learn and exchange knowledge and experience in host schools of partner countries for a semester

I. Any other comments

I1 Please indicate whether your country has faced any constraints, in particular related to global or national crises, including natural disasters, in implementing the 1974 Recommendation during the reporting period.

South Korea, like other parts of the world, is suffering difficulties as a result of the ongoing COVID-19 pandemic. Still, South Korea also regards the pandemic as an indicator of why it is ever more important to pursue SDG 4.7 with commitment and persistence, as it has brought into focus how the world is in fact experiencing a devastating situation akin to 'multiple pandemics' – the intensification of discrimination and polarization, the resurgence of authoritarian populism, the problems of disinformation, and so on. As elaborated in the above sections, there have been numerous efforts by multiple stakeholders in South Korea to highlight the importance of GCED/ESD in this time of crisis and beyond.

- 12 Please provide any other relevant information or clarifications regarding the implementation of the 1974 Recommendation or the mainstreaming of GCED and ESD in your country's education system.